Thoughts and dreams

STATS

I kinda want to have four stats to match tarot suits. It does not really have any other justification.

- Might(Hearts, Cup, Water)
- Finesse(Diamonds, Pentacles, Earth)
- Clarity(Clubs, Wands, Fire)
- Will(Spades, Swords, Air)

The Feat for Finesse would be of accuracy, you can choose one of your weapons and attack only with it. Instead of rolling its weapon dice – treat them as if they rolled their maximum values. Pass Finesse test or become Fatigued.

Working Feat name is "Impale" or "Puncture".

Fourth affliction is a muscle tear that makes you lose finesse the longer it goes untreated

Secondary stat for `Finesse` is `Guard` You choose either the value that you rolled on `d6` or half of what your rolled on `d12`. On the second thought though it appears that it's too much, better is to have `Guard` be just equal to the third of `Finesse`: 1, 2, 3 translates to 1 Dodge, 4, 5, 6 to 2 Dodge and so on.

Also it would be nice to have something that is closer to dodging and evasion instead of `Guard`. Hmm, `Evasion` or `Dodge` is kinda alright actually, but a bit long.

Armour and dodge interaction should contribute to the feeling of heaviness. First piece of armour is free, second and thrid cost 1 `Dodge`. Plates half your `Dodge`. However, if you have full armour set, you get an additional point of armour.

So, maximum armour is 5, shield wall – makes it 6, construct can go up to 7. Maybe if you have no armour at all, you have bonus `Dodge`, like +2?

Double rolls for complex checks

What about mixed rolls???? roll 2d20 and compare the sum against sum of two stats. Am I genius or what.

ATTACK RESOLUTION

Attack resolution can be change to be accommodating.

1. Attacker and defender declares Focus usage
2. Roll with required amount of focus
3. Attacker and defender declare and resolve stress usage
4. Attacker chooses damage die and gambits
5. Attacker resolves damage die and gambits one by one. Defender(or ally for makeshift treatment) rolls virtue checks.
6. Defender(s) chooses which of them are Denied, once denied or resolved – die is lost. Only one damage die can be resolved.
7. Dismount is a virtue loss, not damage. Bolsters after damage die resolution just add +1 damage retroactively for simplicity

That makes combat more "streamy" and in-advance-declarations do not slow it down.

SPELLCASTING & GRAFTING WITH MAGIC INGREDIENTS

See apothecary for weaving and witchcraft details.

Spellweaving is the most intuitive. Spell components should provide gradual benefits within casting.

Witchcraft could use means to smooth their relations with patrons.

Construct can drop certain dice from the pattern to make it easier.

Knights can just eat the thing

It would be fun to have ingredients to have an effect just upon consumption. I think d4 to virtue checks is fun. Also you can probably can negative effects if you fail Might save, like -d4 to saves, for example.

NOTES ABOUT CHARACTER CREATION

Currently there are five distinct kinds of characters that are outlined in the rules.

- Knight
- Spellweaver
- Witch
- Construct
- Apothecary

Those resemble classes and I kinda hate it. However, with revelation upon healing, it is possible to be a full knight and a full witch, just not right after character creation. I like that.

So, probably it is wise to split the rules in such a way that you first learn how to create a basic character and then later you pick something like a profession or credo or something that makes you into one of those four.

I like the idea of, `Profession`, `Interest`, `Passion` and `Burden?` that describe who you are.

Profession is one of those four up there, but construct does not fit, so maybe it should be called something else.

Interest and Burden are to be filled with traits.

But, for example, *Rethreading domain* is unfit for `Burden` if you already know spellcasting, however, it I can see that if you don't know how to weave a spell.

Interest is a potential, where you can have something to develop.

These two are so undercooked its unreal :)

Passion is straight from Mythic Bastionland and, thus, needs to be reworked. I kinda like the idea that this is what your character is and thus you are allowed to write whatever you want there, but there should be some examples that are **NOT** from Bastionland.

Mechanically `Passion` is for `Will` restoration, refilling of spellweaving pools and, maybe, `Stress` reduction.

Trauma recovery

REVELATIONS

Each time you recover from Trauma or Injury – pull a Tarot card.

If you want to roll for tarot card you can roll d100, that will give you a card from Tarot deck with each Major Arcana duplicated. Which might be treated as a plus as that would mean 54/44 odds of pulling Minor/Major arcana.

- `00 - 21` - Major arcana in order(see below)
- `22 - 77` - Minor arcana
  `suite = (i - 22) // 14 + 1` (`Cup`, `Pentacles`, `Clubs`, `Swords`)
  number = `(i - 22) % 14 + 1` (`1-10`, `Page`, `Knight`, `Queen`, `King`)
- `78 - 99` - Major arcana in reversed order(reversed meaning???)

Minor arcana allows you to increase your stats.

Numbered cards increase corresponding virtue by `1` if it does not exceed cards number. `Ace` counts as `15`, just above the `King`, when comparing against virtues.

Court cards allow to increase virtue or corresponding derived stats: `Guard` for `Might` and `Finesse`, `Focus` for `Clarity` and `Stress` for `Will`. Court card number is ten plus their position in the sequence: `Page`, `Knight`, `Queen`, `King`.

You can store you minor arcana instead of immediately using it. If at some point you have several of them stored, you can use them as a single card adding their numbers together, provided that card exist(`15` is the maximum number representing an `Ace`). If suits are different – you choose one of them for the result.

Major arcana is a revelation that character has when going through suffering of healing.

Many of them have several options, you can choose any one of them each time you use it. If not specified otherwise - Arcana can be used only on yourself and only one time.

Some Major Arcanas have properties described by keywords:
- `Depletes`: You start with `d12` as a depletion die. When you use the card, you roll the die. If it rolls `1` - discard the card after effect has taken place, otherwise downface depletion die.
- `Shared`: You can use the card not only on yourself, but on others without penalties.
- `Gift`: You can use the card on others, but you discard it afterwards.

0. The Fool: "Fortune *is* into you".
   - [Depletes, Shared] You can set any die to any value if you are not satisfied with the result. No stress or focus can argue with destiny.
   - Maybe even "redconn" past a bit, when you could have done something, but didn't.
   - Next time you have a revelation, you choose it instead of drawing blindly.

1. The Magician(Clarity):
   - Gives you a spellweaving pool with a single d4 die and *Detect Magic* if you don't have one.
   - Allows you to learn a new spell of your choice
   - Redistribute faceness of dice in a single pool you have.
   - You can learn any *Arcane trait.*

2. High Priestess:
   - Allows you to change your gender(Joan Priestess)?
   - Allows to ask one question and receive truthful answer
   - *listen, trust you intuition, even if logic tells you otherwise*

3. The Empress:
   - Learn any Trait, Feat, Familiar Arcana or Witch spell.
     If you learned a spell, this particular one can be cast without patron and spellweaving pool, but with raw `Clarity` and `Will`. Witch spell costs a virtue per favour.
     In order to cast arcana you spend one point of your virtue to manifest a d4 per point spent. Also you can upface manifested dice by spending a point of virtue per upface. You can't *rethread the arcane* if you don't have a spellweaving pool, you must use all those dice to cast this particular spell.
   - *attract instead of chasing, focus inwards and things you search for will appear.*

4. The Emperor(Might):
   - [Depletes, Gift] You can use The Emperor to clear `Fatigue`
   - *something about force*

5. The Hierophant:
   - *challenge rules(reversed?), but overall it is becoming a pupil again and submitting to hierarchial wisdom. Maybe you are the source of hierarchial wisdom? Can it be that you can find yourself a pupil, squire or disciple? Also can probably interact with Guard, bc why not*

6. The Lovers: "Marriage is nigh!"
   - Redistribute virtues, Guard, Stress, Focus and Injuries between two willing characters.
   - *crossroads, maybe change of passion? Change of something integral to the character, virtues maybe?*

7. The Chariot:
   - [Spendable, Gift] Can help you destroy obstacles that are in your way by giving you ability to overcome them: e.g. crushing through the wall, Breathing underwater for a short while, jumping down to certain death but surviving the fall
   - *something about gearing up and purposefully pursuing your goal. State what you want to achieve and world will provide? You can skip night's rest, but get all the benefits of it.*

8. Strength: "'Tis but a scratch…"
   - [Depletes, Gift] Upon receiving a severe injury you can ignore it.
   - When you receive lethal injury you can discard Strength to ignore it.

9. The Hermit:
   - Reveals location of a Seer, who requires aid and provides valuable reward to the players.
   - Meet the master craftsman who wills to teach/make something in exchange for solving his problems.

10. Wheel of fortune:
    - [Depletes] You can replace any virtue check with luck roll.
    - *Something about being humble both at highs and at lows. Maybe something about having 0 virtue? idk here. Gambling seems ok option.*

11. Justice:
    - [Depletes] Inflicts damage that you receive on those who caused it.
    - *"truth has a longer arc than luck", hmmm.*

12. The Hanged Man:
    - [Depletes, Shared] Overnight rest counts as two. You can wake up at knight to do once-per-day activities an additional time.
    - *something about slowing down and changing perspective*

13. Death:
    - Somebody you know dies suddenly
    - *but for real its more about losing something willingly. But for what? For somebody to lose the same? The idea of losing spell-casting in order for somebody else to lose it is kinda tempting.*

14. Temperance:
    - *Maybe something about not spending stress/focus and receiving more in the end of the day? Spends each day you attempt the commitment.*
    - *??? to similar to hangman and justice. I feel it as if you need to limit yourself in order to achieve something*

15. The Devil(Will):
    - Gives you a patron of your choice
    - You can learn a new spell, including from another patron or Familiar arcana. To weave a spell spend Favour to manifest `d4` that many dice, upface any of them at 1 Favour per upface. You can't *rethread the acrane* if you don't have a spellweaving pool, you can use manifested dice only to cast this particular spell.
    - Learn a Wiccan Trait

16. The Tower(Finesse):
    - Discover yourself as a construct
    - If already a construct – choose a virtue and gain crafting dice as if you have lost all of it.
    - If already a construct – redistribute faceness of your crafting dice.
    - If already a construct – Learn a new pattern
    - If already a construct – Learn a construct trait
    - Obtain materials that you are missing for creating something
    - *Destruction, ruin of illusions, emergence of something real*

17. The Star:
    - [Depletes, Shared] Cure an injury or a trauma
    - [Depletes, Shared] Restore one of the virtues fully
    - *Healing and renewal* Maybe full refill of virtues? Injuries?

18. The Moon:
    - *is about shadow dimension you are gonna be banished to. You can search for wisdom there, but you most likely want to escape. Forbidden arcana?*

19. The Sun:
    - [Depletes, Shared] Restore all Focus
    - [Depletes, Shared] Reduce 2 Stress
    - [Depletes, Shared] Restore all Guard
    - *Rest, vitality, happiness. Resets stress and focus? Traumas?*

20. Judgement:
    - [Depletes] Raises dead at the place they died or if you have a piece of their body. Raised dead last for a day in a from of spirit or a animated body
    - Revive recently dead
    - *An invitation, wake up call*

21. The world:
    - Reshuffle the tarot deck. Increases guard, focus and stress by a single point. Restores virtues up to halves of their maximum.
    - *completion, success and anticipation of renewal of the cycle*

Construct

INTRODUCTION

Knight is kinda associated with `Might`, Spellweaver – with `Clarity` and Witch – with `Will`.

So its natural to have something for `Finesse`. I like something derived from fake body possessed by a soul(a construct?). Each time you fail a virtue check – you lose 1 virtue on your choice. Each time you use `Stress` – you lose 1 virtue point. In turn you are immune to afflictions, have some pain related shenanigans and recover faster during overnight sleeps: `2 + d4`, I think is ok.

BOON OF ALCHEMICAL BASE

Also, it might be cool to have your body produce an alchemical base that would allow you to make potions. If there are potions in the game, certain witches and weavers should be able to craft them through magic, but only you can do it "for free".

BODY MODIFICATIONS

Something-something crafting body parts of those who have fallen recently into your lifeless body. Maybe you track damage you've received through physical impact and decay due to lifelessness of your body.

When healing point in virtue you receive a die: `d4`, `d6`, `d8`, `d10` respectfully. You need to sleep half as much as people who are actually alive, so you can spend that time to augment yourself with those dice.

- There should be some modifications that allow to use those dice directly, like you can "store" a `d10` in your hand in form of a contraption that will enable you to use it combat.
- Grafted wings sound insanely cool, but they probably should have limited usage.
- Retractable blades to free your hands, shields with something interesting on top of them, defensive enhancements of your body.

Grafting roll goes as follows:

1. Choose modification
2. Choose dice, at least as much as the pattern requires
3. Apply `Focus`, roll, apply `Stress`.
4. If you meet the pattern - you can craft the thing. Discard those dice
5. You can pick one dice from the remaining ones and keep it. It represents a useful piece for later that you managed to craft. It is a physical item that you need to carry.

There is a limit to how much your body can handle without failing its motion functions. Each time your body is augmented note the amount of dice that are used in its pattern. Total amount of dice from all modifications installed can't exceed your `Finesse`.

Surprise modifications allow to get a one time advantage over your foes. You can safely install one in each of your limbs and load them with pocket sand, sawdust, darts or whatever unholy shenanigans you can come up with.

Pattern: any two dice that share faceness.

Each socket, when loaded, allows to use one crafting dice that is the same to those used to craft the socket a weapon dice during the attack. The socket can be reloaded on short rest.

Wings allow you to glide indefinitely, fly for up to your current might amount of minutes. After landing random die in the chain breaks, you can't fly before replacing it.

Pattern: dice with consecutive value which start at `1` and sum to you maximum `Might` or more.

Retractable blade hides inside your arm, it frees your hand to use it with non-hefty or long weapon. The weapon you use for the blade can't be heavy, long or hefty. Once the blade is installed, you can use it as if you hold it and hide it on demand.

Pattern: Choose a weapon for the blade, roll its dice twice – this is the pattern. You can't change the pattern for this particular weapon, but you can find another one of the same kind to try.

Infused plating is obtained by installing armour plates into your body.

Pattern: ???

Plates are ruined, by you have a passive point of armour that does not occupy any armour slot. Can't be used with wings.

Non combat things? Change of appearance, voice, steal other people faces? can you slowly turn yourself into animal?

TRAITS

Union of rot construct can use alchemical base synthesised by their body to incorporate pieces of living things onto themselves at a cost of letting the rot in.

Apothecary

HEALING

Current way of healing injuries and traumas is a bit punishing. So the idea is to have "double virtue checks".

Injury can be cured only if both healing and healed characters succeed. They provide their `Finesse` and `Might` respectfully, roll `2d20` and pass the test together. The only problem is that `2d20` now has a bell curve which might make to easy or too hard. So a bit of investigation is needed.

Trauma is cured when the one battling in is able to perceive through it and gather enough courage to leave it behind. In order to succeed they must pass combined `Clarity` and `Will` test. Apothecary can substitute one of those virtues with their own.

POTION BREWING

I like the idea that you need to sacrifice a bit of your Will or Clarity to craft a potion.

There should be a non-magical material component that is required and kinda hard to get and a magical substance that could extract the nature of non-magical component into the potion.

Apothecary draws from inherited magic scattered around them in contrast with weavers who draw their power from themselves and witches drawing powers from their patrons.

Aromatics are designed to soften the attitude of patrons witches rely on for spells. There is no magic to them, the key is to know fitting smell and good methods of delivery: vapors of alcohol, scented oils or water.

- Thaliat, a Laughing spirit
  - Laurel or bog myrtle for backstages
  - Smell of freshly cooked meal or baked bread
  - Honey
  - Fragrance
- Vesna, the Passage guardian
  - Lavender and freshly dug up soil of funerals
  - Smell of blood for when new soul arrives into the world
  - Feral smell of fear of those lacking sophisticated mind
- Aestur, a Ravaging spirit
  - Blood and iron of battle
  - Sweat and smell of sea
- Corrust, a spirit of dwindling
  - Sweetness of rot
  - Dullness of mismanaged fabric
  - Dust of abandoned spaces
  - Humidity of leaking basement

The effect could be one of below or something that is appropriate for the situation.

- Discount on a particular spell
- Obtain temporary favour
- Increase favour you already have
- Skip check for learning new spell

Spell ingredients are not required to perform the weaving, however, they could be very helpful.

- Modify die by a fixed amount or within range.
- Set dice to a particular value or range
- Reroll dice, which should interact with Focus, as they do the same thing
- Change faceness

BASICS OF ALCHEMY

They create a bit of misalignment with virtues, but maybe its actually a good thing.

Alternatives are Water, Earth, Fire and Air which align perfectly with virtues, but provide less identity.

- Sulfur(Soul, combustion, synthesis) it provides means of alchemical binding through combustion.
- Mercury(Sprit, separation, volatility) used when a substance need to be extracted from somewhere and carried into isolation from other substances.
- Salt(Body, rigidity, inertness) fortifies prepared ingredient and stops it from escaping or changing.

These are rough controls over potion preparation that alchemist does. I want players to craft their own potions using essence of things they have laying around.

DETAILS OF ALCHEMY

Alchemical Base is required to extract the essence from mundane objects. It is found within items that existed alongside people who deeply cared about them, in particular, treating them as if they are alive. It could be a doll from somebody's childhood, a deer skull that proud hunter talks with, painting of a loved one treated as if it still holds piece of them.

In order to extract it, put it in salt. Salt would absorb the base slowly and release when heated. However, in order to obtain it without burning – dissolve salt in mercury, heat the mixture but if do not let mercury boil, it will release the base and it will be lost. Let it cool for a while and you will see how base is released as a layer below the metal. Use straw to gather it from there into a glass flask.

If you want to have a full yield – burn the item in sulfur fire and use its ashes for extraction.

POTION RECIPES

Mist of doorlocking is a tricky potion to craft. It requires to have a piece of door handle that wasn't unlocked for a very long time. Potion loses its effect if the door is unlocked after it is brewed.

1. Burn the piece in sulfur
2. Dissolve ashes in alchemical base
3. Evaporate without boiling into a flask

If the potion is correctly brewed you will notice that resulting vapor never condenses. Release it onto a handle and it will be locked as long as the original door is not open. However, if somebody forces themselves through – the original door also opens mirroring the motion.

General thoughts

ENVIRONMENTAL DEPENDENCY OF APOTHECARY

If Apothecary relies on potions both for combat, perhaps akin to an archetypical alchemist, and otherwise – then they overly rely on ingredients that they make potions from. Apothecary can gather, hunt or trade in order to obtain them.

So, if they are transported to another realm, banished into shadow dimension or explore underground they can be deprived of them and from using their character to the full potential.

This is not unsolvable, but needs to be taken into consideration.

EQUIPMENT CAN PROVIDE DODGE

There is an argument to be made that weapons and shield makes you better at deflecting attacks. Armour represents absorption of damage, while guard represent evasion.

It is kinda ok if weapons provide guard in addition of their damage dice. Shield obviously provides guard, axe probably too, even a log would make it easier for you.

So, I would say that it is reasonable to say that when you are actively fencing you have as much additional guard as the amount of damage dice your weapons provide in total. Let's say for simplicity that does not include conditional dice at all.

However, that makes it so characters would have too much additional guard, so, probably, current way of calculating it based on Finesse need to be readjusted.

The downside of all of this is evident: one needs to manage weapon swapping and what happens when you are disarmed and then armed again. Maybe it's too much complexity.

INVENTORY SLOTS

Currently, there is no mechanics managing inventory. Also, there are injury slots…

So, I think that there should be an interaction that governs them, possibly, together. Sometimes implementation of the whole health system is just filling your inventory slots with injuries. When you can't take them any more – you die.

However, that would necessitates dramatic changes to the character sheet.

STOLEN DEFENSE MECHANIC THAT I DON'T KNOW WHERE TO PUT

You have a defense die, you roll it when you take damage. You start with `d12`, for example. You roll the die and if it matches damage, it is negated without consequences. However, on fail you take the damage and downface the die. Next time you have less capabilities to deflect the strike.

This could be a primitive health mechanic. Where you have `6`instances of health(`d12`, `d10`, `d8`, `d6`, `d4`, `d1`) and death occurs when you can't downface your defense die anymore.

Moreover, it is employable as a shield mechanic. Maybe for constructs? This is good idea actually. I can even add an additional die for guard.